

A NEW WAY TO DEVELOP – THE JETPACK API

Learn from the past, look to the future!

By general estimations, about everybody is happy with their browser's extensions. Of the billions that use browsers, 85% have some sort of an extension installed. Over the years, there's been some criticism of the fact that a lot of background knowledge was required for developing what would eventually just be a new feature in the browser.

And so, Jetpack was born. The resounding success that it was, Firefox decided to ship it with the main browser as the official SDK for developing Firefox add-ons six months ago. Till date, while criticism has been directed at the fact that it's still very limited in its capabilities, this will obviously improve as time goes by. For now, the attempt at standardising some of the more rogue elements of extension development is well appreciated.

Now, let's examine Jetpack's internals, within which a few segregations can be made. The top level difference is the depth of features. Jetpack offers both high-level and low-level APIs, and we'll take this space to try and